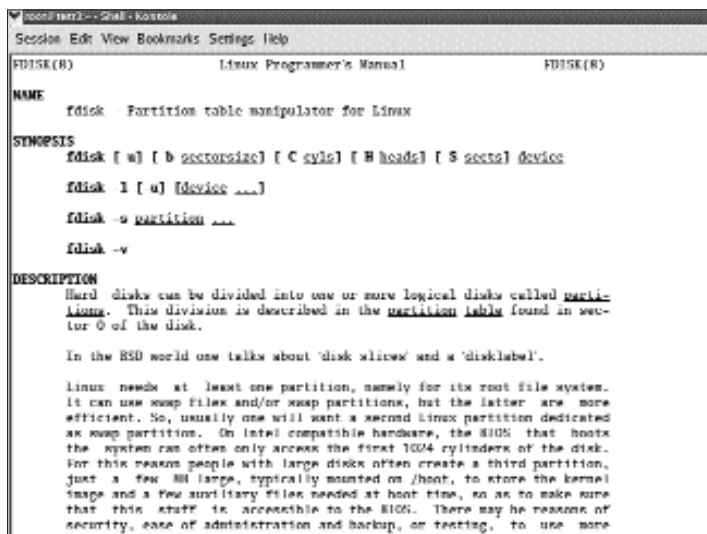




```
root@mint2: ~ - Shell - Konsole
Session Edit View Bookmarks Settings Help
FDISK(8)                                Linux Programmer's Manual          FDISK(8)

NAME
    fdisk  Partition table manipulator for Linux

SYNOPSIS
    fdisk [ -u ] [ -b sectorsize ] [ -C cyls ] [ -H heads ] [ -S sector ] device
    fdisk 1 [ -u ] [device ...]
    fdisk -s partition ...
    fdisk -v

DESCRIPTION
    Hard disks can be divided into one or more logical disks called partitions. This division is described in the partition table found in sector 0 of the disk.

    In the BSD world one talks about 'disk slices' and a 'disklabel'.

    Linux needs at least one partition, namely for its root file system. It can use swap files and/or swap partitions, but the latter are more efficient. So, usually one will want a second Linux partition dedicated as swap partition. On Intel compatible hardware, the BIOS that boots the system can often only access the first 1024 cylinders of the disk. For this reason people with large disks often create a third partition, just a few MB large, typically mounted on /boot, to store the kernel image and a few auxiliary files needed at boot time, so as to make sure that this stuff is accessible to the BIOS. There may be reasons of security, ease of administration and backup, or testing, to use more
```

man is used to get information on any other command. This screen is the result of the command `man fdisk`

It's now time for some basic commands, just so you get a feel of the power that Linux vests you with.

2.5.4 Some Very Useful, Basic Commands

The first command you learn in any OS is to display files in a directory: in DOS, you would type "**dir**" to display the contents of a folder. In Linux, the equivalent is the "**ls**" command. This command displays the files and folders in the current directory. The "**ls**" command comes with some extra options; "**ls -l**" produces a "long list" that shows the owner, group, size, date modified and permissions. "**ls -a**" will list hidden files as well. In DOS, this is done by "**dir /a**". There are other options—which we will leave to you to explore.

Changing the current (working) folder is accomplished by "**cd <directoryname>**". The directory you want to change to is included after the **cd** and a blank space. When you want to return to the home directory, you simply need to type in **cd** and press **[Enter]**. To go one directory up, just type "**cd ..**" and hit **[Enter]**.